

Stage 2: Section 8 Court & Possession Pack**What Happens Next****READY FOR COURT - CLAIM FILE ALIGNED**

Prepare and issue the possession claim using the forms and guidance in this pack once the claim is eligible on or after 6 April 2026.

STEP 1**Issue the claim when eligible**

Issue the possession claim once the notice period has expired and no earlier than 6 April 2026.

STEP 2**Prepare for the hearing**

At the hearing, the court will consider notice validity, service, whether the grounds apply, and whether the arrears are proved. Keep the file updated to the latest practicable date.

STEP 3**Move to possession or enforcement**

If possession is granted, follow the date to leave in the order. If the tenant does not leave, move straight into warrant or enforcement steps using the same continuous file.

After court preparation

Keep the issued claim, service record, hearing bundle, and any later enforcement papers aligned in the same case file.

This pack continues the case started with the notice. The more clearly the notice, claim, hearing bundle, and enforcement papers line up, the less room there is for avoidable challenge.